

Wichita Is First Up for Cohen's Indians

By LESTER KOELLING

The gates will swing open at Victory Field tonight to welcome home the Indianapolis Indians, returning from a successful 16-day road trip.

Although the Indians dropped their road windup game, 6-1, in Louisville last night, they can be proud of their record of nine victories against seven defeats. Even though three of the triumphs were gained at the expense of the weak Colonels, it is significant that the Indians held their own against the better clubs of the league, breaking even in 12 games with Minneapolis, St. Paul, Denver and Charleston.



Koelling

First opponent for the Indians in the seven-day home stand will be league-leading Wichita, managed by Ben Geraghty, former Indianapolis second baseman who has gained a measure of fame as a manager in the Milwaukee organization. Single games are scheduled tonight and tomorrow night and a double-header at 1:30 Sunday.

The Indians experienced their worst performance at the plate in 12 days when Dave Benedict, a southpaw, limited them to five hits in the Louisville windup. The hurler, who has won three of Louisville's four games, lost his shutout when Sam Mele homered in the ninth.

Mele's homer, incidentally, enabled the Indians to continue their extra-base hitting streak which now is 23 straight games. Prior to Mele's four-bagger, only four singles were obtained off Benedict.

Since leaving home 16 days ago, and despite their defeat last night, the Indians have overcome many of their early weaknesses. They are, for example, one of the top hitting clubs in the league and their defense has tightened in keeping with the improvement at the plate.

Only the pitching needs to come around more to make the Tribe a first-division contender. That, too, has been progressing steadily along with some solid relief pitching.

Additional pitching talent is expected from the Chicago White Sox, who are four over the player limit which goes into effect next Wednesday. At that time the Indians also will be obliged to reduce their roster to the league limit of 20 players, and it won't be an easy pruning job for Manager Andy Cohen, particularly when the White Sox sends additional talent to the club.

Shortening of the Tribe roster actually began last night with the assignment of

TRIBE BOX SCORE

INDIANAPOLIS (11)												
	*B.Avg.	AB	BB	R	H	O	A	E				
Prohovich, 3b...	.186	3	1	0	1	0	0	0				
Garcia, 2b....	.302	4	0	0	0	1	5	0				
Delsing, rf, cf...	.352	4	0	0	2	4	0	0				
Jackson, 1b....	.322	3	1	0	0	13	0	0				
Mele, lf, rf....	.357	4	0	1	1	1	0	0				
Beard, cf....	.349	2	0	0	0	0	0	0				
bDiTuso, cf....	.327	2	0	0	0	0	0	0				
Hairston, c....	.254	4	0	0	0	3	0	0				
Valdivielso, ss....	.231	4	0	0	1	2	4	0				
DuFour, p....	.333	1	0	0	0	0	3	0				
aWilliams....	.333	1	0	0	0	0	0	0				
Bicknell, p....	.200	0	0	0	0	0	0	0				
cRomano....	.265	1	0	0	0	0	0	0				
Howard, p....	.000	0	0	0	0	0	0	0				
	.294	33	2	1	5	24	14	0				

*At start of game.
aField out for DuFour in 6th.
bSafe on error for Beard in 7th.
cGrounded out for Bicknell in 8th.

LOUISVILLE (6)												
	*B.Avg.	AB	BB	R	H	O	A	E				
Moore, ss....	.304	4	0	0	0	1	0	0				
Rivers, 2b....	.246	4	0	0	0	1	1	0				
Dunham, rf....	.327	4	0	2	3	5	0	0				
Eggert, 3b....	.255	4	0	1	2	1	2	0				
Rapp, c....	.274	4	0	1	1	2	1	0				
McCord, 1b....	.242	4	0	1	1	1	0	0				
Phillips, cf....	.239	2	1	1	1	7	0	0				
Brown, lf....	.200	3	0	0	1	1	0	0				
Benedict, p....	.000	3	0	0	1	0	3	0				
	.32	1	6	10	27	8	0					

*At start of game.
Indianapolis..... 000 000 001-1
Louisville..... 000 401 01x-6
Runs batted in—Rapp, Brown 3, Phillips, Eggert, Mele. Two-base hits—Dunham, Brown, Eggert (2). Home run—Mele. Double plays—Valdivielso to Garcia to Jackson; Valdivielso (unassisted). Left on base—Indianapolis 7, Louisville 3.

PITCHING SUMMARY												
	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	WP					
DuFour.....	5	5	4	4	1	3	0					
Bicknell.....	2	3	1	1	0	0	0					
Howard.....	1	2	1	1	0	0	0					
Benedict.....	9	5	1	1	2	2	0					
Winning pitcher—Benedict (3-1). Losing pitcher—DuFour (1-1). Umpires—Phillips, Stewart and Carabba. Time—1:35. Attendance—435.												

TRIBE AT HOME

TONIGHT—Wichita, 7:45.

TOMORROW—Wichita, 7:45 p.m.

SUNDAY — Wichita (Double-Header), 1:30 p.m.

MONDAY—Charleston (Ladies Night), 7:45 p.m.

TUESDAY — Charleston (But-boy Night), 7:45 p.m.

WEDNESDAY — Charleston, 7:45 p.m.

THURSDAY—Charleston, 7:45 p.m.

Arnie Atkins and Don Rudolph to the Louisville club. Atkins, bought by Indians, Inc., from San Diego last winter, was sold to the Colonels, and Rudolph's Chicago White Sox option was transferred. Both are due to join the Colonels immediately.

Manager Cohen feels that with adequate pitching he will have a good chance to reach and remain in the first division. He is fairly well satisfied with the rest of the club although he would like to have a catcher of considerable Triple-A or major league experience to nurse along his young pitchers.

Recent performances of Don Prohovich, both at the plate and in the field, have been encouraging, but there still is no assurance that the rookie will stand the gaff of Triple-A competition. Considering that he had played only 70 pro games in Class A before breaking into the Indianapolis lineup it's asking much of him to make his mark with Indianapolis this year.

Prohovich has delivered some key hits in recent Tribe games, but it must be admitted that they have come off pitchers not regarded as among the best in the league. Nevertheless, Don has a good swing and he just might find himself against all types of pitching. A manager hesitates to "give up" on a fellow like Prohovich.

TONITE

VICTORY FIELD

Your Indians vs. Wichita

BASEBALL

Game Time 7:45 P.M.—Kids Free

Tomorrow Wichita at 7:45 P.M.